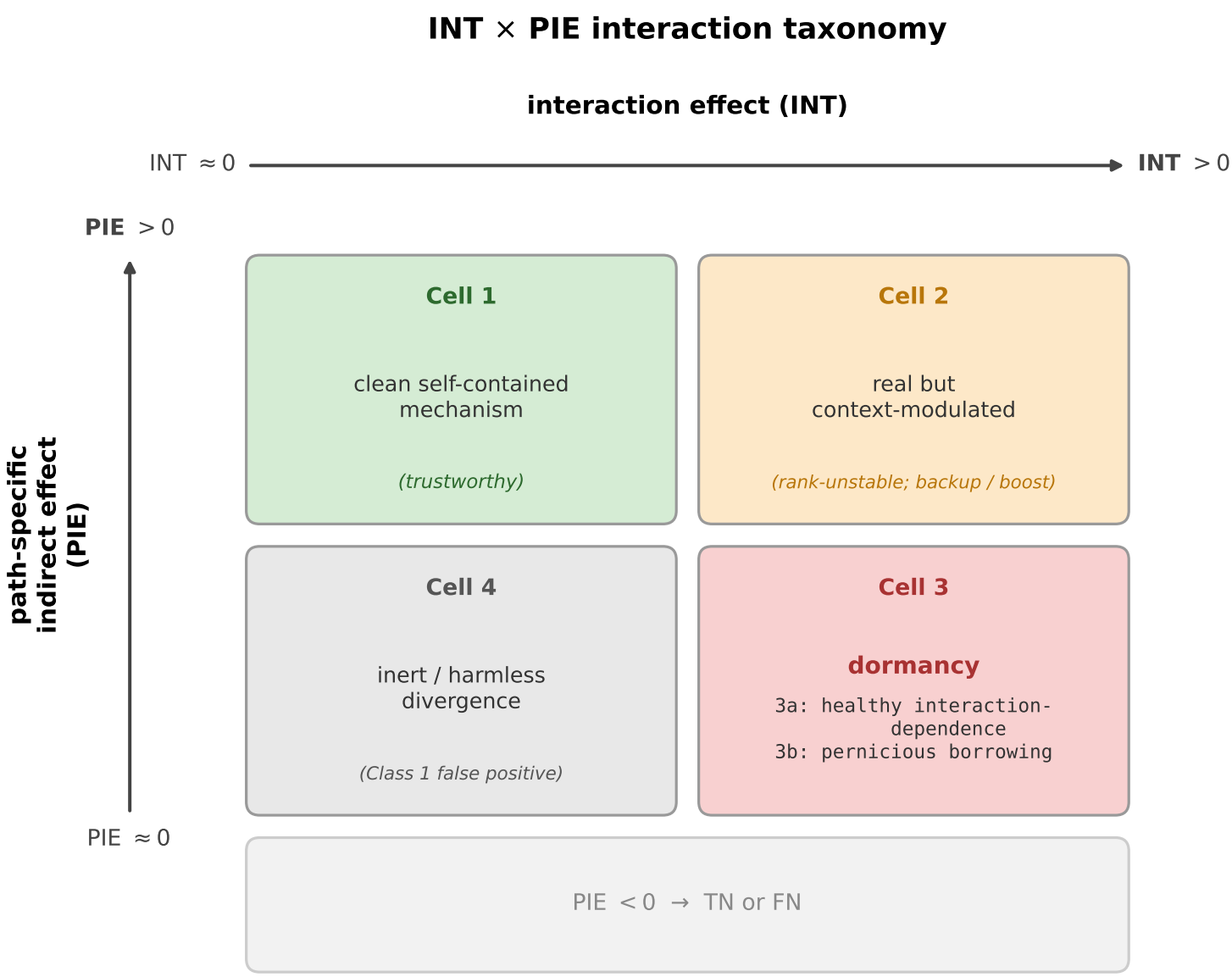
INT × PIE interaction taxonomy
interaction effect (INT)
INT ≈ 0
INT > 0
PIE > 0
path-specific indirect effect (PIE)
PIE ≈ 0
Cell 1
clean self-contained mechanism
(trustworthy)
Cell 2
real but context-modulated
(rank-unstable; backup / boost)
Cell 4
inert / harmless divergence
(Class 1 false positive)
Cell 3
dormancy
3a: healthy interaction-dependence
3b: pernicious borrowing
PIE < 0 → TN or FN